

Mahagonny-Songspiel in 1927, later expanded into a full opera. The following year, their Die Dreigroschenoper, transposing John Gay's Threepenny Opera to modern Berlin, proved a sensational success. Brecht-Weill songs such as Mack the Knife and Alabama Song became ubiquitous popular hits. Jewish and left-wing, Weill fled Germany when Hitler took power in 1933. He divorced Lenya, only to marry her again in 1937. Living in the US, he became a hugely successful writer of tuneful Broadway shows, from the musical comedy Knickerbocker Glory to the "folk opera" Street Scene.

KEY WORKS: Die Dreigroschenoper, 1928; Aufstieg und Fall der Stadt Mahagonny (opera), 1930; Knickerbocker Holiday (operetta), 1938; Street Scene (opera), 1946